



Kinfield Navigator

Family Action Plan for Dorothy Mason

Prepared for Helen Mason, daughter

Date	22 September 2026
Plan version	Version 1.0
Plan reference	AP-DM9105

This plan contains personal information. Please share it only with people involved in Dot's care.

Your plan at a glance

KEY PRIORITIES

- Now** Plan a safe return home
- Now** Arrange regular breaks for the carer
- Now** Support Helen as the main carer
- Now** Prepare for a move into care
- Soon** Make the home safer

WHAT NEEDS ATTENTION

- Plan a safe return home
- Arrange regular breaks for the carer
- Support Helen as the main carer
- Prepare for a move into care

27 actions in this plan, 10 to start now.

RECOMMENDED NEXT STEP

Confirm support is in place for the first two weeks (before discharge)

Your top priorities

- 1 Plan a safe return home** **Now**
Dot came home from hospital recently after a chest infection.
- 2 Arrange regular breaks for the carer** **Now**
Some respite has been used, but more regular breaks may be needed.
- 3 Support Helen as the main carer** **Now**
Helen (daughter) is the main carer.
- 4 Prepare for a move into care** **Now**
Dot has been assessed as needing hospital-level care.
- 5 Make the home safer** **Soon**
You mentioned: cannot manage the stairs any more.

What you told us

Dorothy Mason, 91, lives with family in a house in Dunedin.

Dot uses a wheelchair and has had three falls in the past year.

Health conditions include parkinson's disease and macular degeneration.

The family has noticed noticeable memory changes.

Dot was recently discharged from hospital after a chest infection.

Current support: help from family and personal care (14 hours a week).

Helen (daughter) is the main carer and describes the strain as high.

What matters most: find a care home close to Helen and keep Mum comfortable.

Recommended next steps

PRIORITY	ACTION	WHO	WHEN
Now			
Now	Confirm support is in place for the first two weeks Check who visits, when, and what happens if support does not arrive.	Family with the discharge planner	Before discharge
Now	Check medicines against the discharge letter Remove stopped medicines from the home and ask the pharmacist to review the new list.	Family with the pharmacist	First day home
Now	Ask about the Carer Support Subsidy Raise it at the needs assessment or call the NASC service directly.	Helen	Within 2 weeks
Now	Book a first short break Start with a few hours or a day programme so everyone gets used to it.	Family	Within a month
Now	Book a health check for Helen Mention the caring role, sleep and stress so the GP can help.	Helen	Within a month
Now	Share caring tasks across the family Agree who covers appointments, shopping, paperwork and regular visits.	Family	Within 2 weeks
Now	Visit care homes and check vacancies Visit at least two homes at different times of day, and ask about extra charges.	Family	Within a month
Now	Book a GP falls review Ask for a medication review and checks of eyesight, blood pressure and feet.	Helen Mason	Within 2 weeks

PRIORITY	ACTION	WHO	WHEN
Now	Start the Residential Care Subsidy application Gather income and asset details for the application; it can be backdated only in limited cases.	Family or EPOA attorney	Within 2 weeks
Now	Book a GP memory assessment Describe specific examples of the changes and when they started.	Helen Mason	Within 2 weeks
Soon			
Soon	Walk through the home for hazards Check lighting, loose mats, clutter on floors, and how easy it is to get in and out of the shower and bed.	Family	Within a month
Soon	List the daily tasks that need help Note what is hard each day (showering, meals, shopping, medicines) so support can be matched to real needs.	Helen Mason	This week
Soon	Ask the pharmacy about blister packs Pre-packed medicines by day and time reduce missed or doubled doses.	Family with the pharmacist	Within 2 weeks
Soon	Compare private home support while waiting If funded help will take time, a few privately paid hours can bridge the gap.	Family	Within a month
Soon	Start a strength and balance programme Find a local class or ask for a referral to an in-home programme.	Dot with family support	Within a month
Soon	Ask for an occupational therapy home assessment An occupational therapist can recommend rails, seating and changes that make moving around safer.	Family with the GP	Within a month
Soon	Check current entitlements Ask Work and Income which allowances apply, such as help with extra costs from a health condition.	Helen Mason	Within a month
Soon	Contact a local dementia support service Ask about education sessions, day programmes and support for family carers.	Family	Within a month
Soon	Set up memory supports at home A large clock and calendar, labelled cupboards and a regular daily routine reduce confusion.	Family	Within a month
Soon	Check eligibility for Total Mobility Ask the GP or a local agency about an assessment.	Family	Within a month

PRIORITY	ACTION	WHO	WHEN
Soon	Fit bathroom rails and a shower seat The bathroom is the most common place for falls at home.	Family	Within a month
Soon	Add rails on both sides of stairs Make sure stairs are well lit, with rails that can be gripped firmly.	Family	Within a month
Soon	Make a one-page emergency sheet List medicines, conditions, allergies and contacts, and keep it on the fridge.	Family	Within 2 weeks
Soon	Agree a backup plan if the main carer is unwell Decide who steps in, and how respite could be arranged at short notice.	Family	Within a month
Plan ahead			
Plan ahead	Write a simple money snapshot List income, savings, regular costs and the value of the home, so options can be compared.	Family or EPOA attorney	Within a month
Plan ahead	Find one regular weekly activity A club, class, church group or day programme that Dot would enjoy.	Family	Within 2 months
Plan ahead	Check hearing and eyesight Untreated hearing or vision loss often makes social contact harder.	Dot with family	Within 3 months

Your action plan, by topic

Only the topics that apply to Dot are included.

Hospital discharge

Now

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Dot came home from hospital recently after a chest infection.

WHY THIS MATTERS

The first weeks after hospital carry the highest risk of another admission. A clear plan for support, medicines and follow-up makes a safe return much more likely.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Confirm support is in place for the first two weeks** · Before discharge · Family with the discharge planner
Check who visits, when, and what happens if support does not arrive.
- ☐ **Check medicines against the discharge letter** · First day home · Family with the pharmacist
Remove stopped medicines from the home and ask the pharmacist to review the new list.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Ward discharge planner · Hospital social worker · GP · NASC

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

Hospital team

- What support will Dot need at home, and who will arrange it before discharge?
- Which medicines have changed, and why?
- What follow-up appointments are booked, and who do we call if things go wrong?

Respite

Now

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Some respite has been used, but more regular breaks may be needed.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Regular breaks protect the carer's own health, and that is often what keeps care at home sustainable.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Ask about the Carer Support Subsidy** · Within 2 weeks · Helen
Raise it at the needs assessment or call the NASC service directly.
- ☐ **Book a first short break** · Within a month · Family
Start with a few hours or a day programme so everyone gets used to it.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

NASC · Day programmes · Residential respite providers

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

NASC

- Is Helen eligible for the Carer Support Subsidy, and how can it be used?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Carer Support Subsidy [2]

Reimburses part of the cost of a break for full-time unpaid carers. It is allocated through a NASC needs assessment and can pay for a relief carer, a day programme or short residential respite.

Planning breaks [3]

The Ministry of Social Development's guide for carers explains respite options and how to plan them.

OPTIONS THAT MAY SUIT

Shown because they match Dot's criteria, not as recommendations. Sample providers for testing.

Glenlea Care Lodge

Matches: Location: Otago; Care level: hospital; Budget: up to \$1,600 a week; Availability: vacancy or capacity now

Silverstream Memory Care

Matches: Location: Otago; Care level: hospital; Budget: up to \$1,600 a week

Does not match: Availability: waiting list

Support for the family carer

Now

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Helen (daughter) is the main carer.
- Helen is under a lot of strain and may be close to exhaustion.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Family carers often put their own health last. If the main carer becomes unwell, the whole care arrangement can fall apart quickly.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Book a health check for Helen** · Within a month · Helen
Mention the caring role, sleep and stress so the GP can help.

☐ **Share caring tasks across the family** · Within 2 weeks · Family

Agree who covers appointments, shopping, paperwork and regular visits.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Carer's own GP · Carers NZ · Wider family and friends

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

GP

- Can Helen have a health check that takes the caring role into account?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Carers NZ [10]

Carers NZ provides information, advice and peer support for family carers.

Residential care

Now

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Dot has been assessed as needing hospital-level care.
- The family is considering residential care as soon as possible.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Choosing a care home is easier with time to visit, compare and apply for funding, rather than deciding during a crisis.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

☐ **Visit care homes and check vacancies** · Within a month · Family

Visit at least two homes at different times of day, and ask about extra charges.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

NASC · Care home managers · Work and Income · Lawyer or EPOA attorney

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

Care home

- Do you have a vacancy at hospital level, and what are the extra charges?
- How do you support new residents and families in the first weeks?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Levels of care [6]

Aged residential care in New Zealand is provided at rest home, hospital, dementia and psychogeriatric levels. The level is confirmed by a needs assessment.

OPTIONS THAT MAY SUIT

Shown because they match Dot's criteria, not as recommendations. Sample providers for testing.

Glenlea Care Lodge

Matches: Location: Otago; Care level: hospital; Budget: up to \$1,600 a week; Availability: vacancy or capacity now

Silverstream Memory Care

Matches: Location: Otago; Care level: hospital; Budget: up to \$1,600 a week

Does not match: Availability: waiting list

Staying safely at home

Soon

WHAT WE NOTICED

- You mentioned: cannot manage the stairs any more.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Small changes at home, such as working alarms, good lighting and a way to call for help, prevent many emergencies and make it more likely someone can keep living at home.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Walk through the home for hazards** · Within a month · Family

Check lighting, loose mats, clutter on floors, and how easy it is to get in and out of the shower and bed.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Family and neighbours · GP or practice nurse · Occupational therapist · Fire and Emergency New Zealand

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

GP

- Would Dot qualify for a funded personal alarm, and how do we arrange it?

Occupational therapist

- Which changes in the home would make the biggest difference to safety?

Home care and support

Soon

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Dot currently has help from family and personal care (14 hours a week).
- Dot needs help with moving around, which makes personal care and daily tasks harder.
- Taking medicines correctly has become difficult without help.

WHY THIS MATTERS

The right mix of help, from a few hours of household support to daily personal care, is often what makes staying at home possible and safe.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **List the daily tasks that need help** · This week · Helen Mason
Note what is hard each day (showering, meals, shopping, medicines) so support can be matched to real needs.
- ☐ **Ask the pharmacy about blister packs** · Within 2 weeks · Family with the pharmacist
Pre-packed medicines by day and time reduce missed or doubled doses.
- ☐ **Compare private home support while waiting** · Within a month · Family
If funded help will take time, a few privately paid hours can bridge the gap.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Needs Assessment and Service Coordination (NASC) · GP · Home support providers · Pharmacist

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

NASC

- What funded home support could Dot be eligible for, and how long is the wait?

Pharmacist

- Could medicines be supplied in blister packs, and can the pharmacy review them?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Funded support starts with an assessment [1]

Health New Zealand funds home support for eligible older people after a needs assessment by the local NASC service. A GP can make the referral.

Falls and mobility

Soon

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Dot has had three falls in the last 12 months.
- Dot is worried about falling, which can lead to moving less and becoming weaker.

WHY THIS MATTERS

One fall makes another more likely. Many falls can be prevented with a medication review, strength and balance exercise, and a safer home.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Book a GP falls review** · Within 2 weeks · Helen Mason
Ask for a medication review and checks of eyesight, blood pressure and feet.

- ☐ **Start a strength and balance programme** · Within a month · Dot with family support
Find a local class or ask for a referral to an in-home programme.
- ☐ **Ask for an occupational therapy home assessment** · Within a month · Family with the GP
An occupational therapist can recommend rails, seating and changes that make moving around safer.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

GP · Physiotherapist · Occupational therapist · Live Stronger for Longer classes

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

GP

- Could any of Dot's medicines be adding to dizziness or falls?
- Should eyesight, blood pressure or bone health be checked after these falls?

Physiotherapist

- Which strength and balance programme suits Dot now?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Strength and balance [7]

Live Stronger for Longer lists community strength and balance classes around New Zealand, and GPs can refer people to an in-home programme.

Government funding

Soon

WHAT WE NOTICED

- The family has some concerns about the cost of care.
- The family is considering an application for the Residential Care Subsidy.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Several government subsidies depend on assessments and applications that take time. Starting early avoids paying costs that could have been covered.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Check current entitlements** · Within a month · Helen Mason
Ask Work and Income which allowances apply, such as help with extra costs from a health condition.
- ☐ **Start the Residential Care Subsidy application** · Within 2 weeks · Family or EPOA attorney
Gather income and asset details for the application; it can be backdated only in limited cases.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Work and Income · NASC · Budgeting services · Lawyer or financial adviser

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

Work and Income

- Which subsidies or allowances could Dot be eligible for now?

NASC

- Does Dot's assessed level of care allow a subsidy application?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Residential Care Subsidy [4]

Helps pay for long-term rest home or hospital care after a needs assessment. It is income and asset tested; as at 1 July 2026 the asset thresholds are \$300,811 (Threshold A) and \$164,731 (Threshold B), and they change each year.

Residential Care Loan [5]

If assets are over the threshold mainly because of a home, a Residential Care Loan from Work and Income may help cover care costs.

Dementia and memory changes

Soon

WHAT WE NOTICED

- The family has noticed memory or thinking changes, but there is no diagnosis yet.

WHY THIS MATTERS

An early assessment opens the door to support, treatment of other causes, and planning while Dot can still take part in decisions.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Book a GP memory assessment** · Within 2 weeks · Helen Mason

Describe specific examples of the changes and when they started.

- ☐ **Contact a local dementia support service** · Within a month · Family

Ask about education sessions, day programmes and support for family carers.

- ☐ **Set up memory supports at home** · Within a month · Family

A large clock and calendar, labelled cupboards and a regular daily routine reduce confusion.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

GP · Alzheimers New Zealand or Dementia New Zealand local services · Older persons' mental health team

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

GP

- Could these changes have another cause, such as medication, infection or low mood?

- Should Dot be referred to a memory service or specialist?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Local dementia support [9]

Alzheimers New Zealand and its member organisations offer information, education and support for people living with dementia and their families.

OPTIONS THAT MAY SUIT

Shown because they match Dot's criteria, not as recommendations. Sample providers for testing.

Memory Café Network (community)

Matches: Location: Otago; Availability: vacancy or capacity now

Transport

Soon

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Getting to appointments and shops has become difficult.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Losing transport often leads to missed appointments and isolation. Subsidised options can keep someone independent.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Check eligibility for Total Mobility** · Within a month · Family
Ask the GP or a local agency about an assessment.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Total Mobility agencies · Community transport services · GP (for driving fitness)

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

GP

- Is Dot still safe to drive, and should a driving assessment be done?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Total Mobility [8]

Subsidised taxi and ride-share fares for people who cannot use public transport safely because of an impairment. Eligibility is assessed by an approved agency and subsidies vary by region.

Equipment and home changes

Soon

WHAT WE NOTICED

- The home has stairs Dot needs to use.
- Moving around the home safely needs some support.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Rails, shower seats and the right mobility aids are low-cost changes that prevent falls and keep people independent for longer.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Fit bathroom rails and a shower seat** · Within a month · Family

The bathroom is the most common place for falls at home.

- ☐ **Add rails on both sides of stairs** · Within a month · Family

Make sure stairs are well lit, with rails that can be gripped firmly.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Occupational therapist · Equipment suppliers · Builder for rails and ramps

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

Occupational therapist

- Which equipment is funded, and which would we need to buy?

Emergency planning

Soon

WHAT WE NOTICED

- If Helen became unwell suddenly, there is no backup plan for Dot's care.

WHY THIS MATTERS

A one-page emergency sheet and a backup carer plan save precious time when something unexpected happens.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Make a one-page emergency sheet** · Within 2 weeks · Family

List medicines, conditions, allergies and contacts, and keep it on the fridge.

- ☐ **Agree a backup plan if the main carer is unwell** · Within a month · Family

Decide who steps in, and how respite could be arranged at short notice.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Family · GP · Pharmacist

USEFUL INFORMATION

Emergency kits ^[12]

Get Ready explains how to prepare a household emergency plan, including medicines and mobility needs.

Financial considerations

[Plan ahead](#)

WHAT WE NOTICED

- The family has a guide budget of about \$1,600 a week for care or accommodation.
- Dot owns their home, which affects subsidies and how a move could be funded.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Retirement villages and residential care have very different costs and contracts. Understanding them early avoids rushed decisions.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Write a simple money snapshot** · Within a month · Family or EPOA attorney

List income, savings, regular costs and the value of the home, so options can be compared.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Financial adviser · Lawyer · Free budgeting services

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

Financial adviser

- How would each option affect Dot's income and assets over five years?

Social connection

[Plan ahead](#)

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Dot sees people less often than before.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Loneliness affects mood, memory and physical health. One regular activity each week makes a real difference.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Find one regular weekly activity** · Within 2 months · Family

A club, class, church group or day programme that Dot would enjoy.

- ☐ **Check hearing and eyesight** · Within 3 months · Dot with family

Untreated hearing or vision loss often makes social contact harder.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Age Concern · Local community groups · Church or cultural groups

USEFUL INFORMATION

Visiting services ^[11]

Age Concern runs visiting and social programmes for older people in many parts of New Zealand.

OPTIONS THAT MAY SUIT

Shown because they match Dot's criteria, not as recommendations. Sample providers for testing.

Memory Café Network (community)

Matches: Location: Otago; Availability: vacancy or capacity now

Action checklist

Tick actions off as they are done. Your navigator can update the plan with your progress.

Now

- ☐ Confirm support is in place for the **first two weeks** · Before discharge
- ☐ Check medicines against the **discharge letter** · First day home
- ☐ Ask about the **Carer Support Subsidy** · Within 2 weeks
- ☐ Book a **first short break** · Within a month
- ☐ Book a **health check for Helen** · Within a month
- ☐ Share caring tasks across the **family** · Within 2 weeks
- ☐ Visit care homes and check **vacancies** · Within a month
- ☐ Book a **GP falls review** · Within 2 weeks
- ☐ Start the **Residential Care Subsidy application** · Within 2 weeks
- ☐ Book a **GP memory assessment** · Within 2 weeks

Soon

- ☐ Walk through the home for **hazards** · Within a month
- ☐ List the daily tasks that need **help** · This week
- ☐ Ask the pharmacy about **blister packs** · Within 2 weeks
- ☐ Compare private home support while **waiting** · Within a month
- ☐ Start a **strength and balance programme** · Within a month
- ☐ Ask for an **occupational therapy home assessment** · Within a month
- ☐ Check current **entitlements** · Within a month
- ☐ Contact a local **dementia support service** · Within a month
- ☐ Set up **memory supports at home** · Within a month
- ☐ Check eligibility for **Total Mobility** · Within a month
- ☐ Fit bathroom **rails and a shower seat** · Within a month
- ☐ Add rails on both sides of **stairs** · Within a month
- ☐ Make a **one-page emergency sheet** · Within 2 weeks
- ☐ Agree a **backup plan if the main carer is unwell** · Within a month

Plan ahead

- ☐ Write a **simple money snapshot** · Within a month
- ☐ Find one **regular weekly activity** · Within 2 months

☐ Check hearing and eyesight · Within 3 months

We can help you carry this out

Kinfield Navigator can help your family work through this plan: making calls, preparing for assessments and appointments, comparing options and updating the plan as things change.

Phone 0123456789 · **Email** plans@kinfield.example

Sources and important information

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9. Alzheimers New Zealand, Alzheimers New Zealand. <https://alzheimers.org.nz/> (reviewed 22 September 2026)
10. Carers NZ, Carers New Zealand. <https://carers.net.nz/> (reviewed 22 September 2026)
11. Age Concern New Zealand, Age Concern New Zealand. <https://ageconcern.org.nz/> (reviewed 22 September 2026)
12. Get Ready: emergency preparedness, National Emergency Management Agency. <https://getready.govt.nz/> (reviewed 22 September 2026)

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This plan gives general information based on what your family told us. It is not medical, legal or financial advice. Eligibility for funding and services is decided by the agencies involved, and details such as thresholds change over time. Please check with the relevant professional before making decisions.